

Mañjuśrī's Questions

Toh 546 · Derge Kangyur

འཇམ་དཔལ་གཞི་ནུ་གུ་པའི་ཞུ་པ།

Toh 546 in the Kangyur is a short esoteric scripture centered on the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, known in Sanskrit as Mañjuśrī and in Tibetan as Jampal Zhönnu (ཇམཔལ་ཞེ་ནུ་འབྲུ་པུ་ཤེས་པ་ལྷ་མོ་), the youthful emanation of wisdom. The text belongs to the class of vidyā or dhāraṇī literature, presenting a sacred mantra-formula that Mañjuśrī rises to proclaim before the Buddha and the assembled retinue, who greet his intention with enthusiastic approval. As a dhāraṇī text, it combines narrative framing — in which Mañjuśrī performs devotional prostrations and addresses the Blessed One — with the transmission of a potent vidyā said to be a source of wonder when proclaimed. It is preserved among the dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur, reflecting the canonical importance of Mañjuśrī as a focal deity for wisdom-oriented ritual and recitation practice.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Gentle Protector.

Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, in his youthful form, rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and, facing the Blessed One, pressed his palms together, bowed, and touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, I shall now demonstrate a vidyā. If this supreme vidyā is proclaimed, it will be a source of wonder." The entire retinue present praised the bodhisattva, the great being Mañjuśrī, saying "Excellent!" And so: "Excellent, Mañjuśrī! Excellent! Mañjuśrī, please recite the vidyā. I shall speak it with the speech of the Blessed One."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Mañjuśrī, paid homage to the heart of all buddhas and to all phenomena, made offerings, and recited the vidyā:

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ. Namo Mañjuśrīye bodhisattvāya. Oṃ mañjavar
mañjaghoṣa. Hana hana. Paca paca. Matam ta. Matha matha. Vidhvamsaya
vidhvamsaya. Kara kara. Truṭa truṭa. Bhañja bhañja. Abhisa abhisa. Tuṭa tuṭa.
Truṭa truṭa. Sphuṭa sphuṭa. Hṛdaya-bandhani. Namaḥ saṃbodhani. Prabhesa
prabhesa. Loṭa loṭa. Kṛta gṛta. Krida krida. Kriṭa kriṭa. Hasa hasa. Prabandha
prabandha. Āviśa āviśa. Hūm hūm hūm. Phat phat phat svāhā.

Whoever recites this three times at midnight and seven times at sunrise will attain the great vidyā. They will hold in mind three hundred ślokas of human composition. The ritual procedure for this is as follows: one constructs a maṇḍala of sandalwood, makes offerings with butter lamps using clarified butter, and recites it eight thousand times, whereupon it will be accomplished. Even if it is not yet fully accomplished, one will retain one hundred ślokas for each day of practice.

"Blessed One, if this teaching of mine does not accomplish its result —

Translator's Notes

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, and the translation reflects this abrupt ending faithfully. The "vidyā" here refers to a dhāraṇī-maṇṭra, and the term vidyā-dhāraṇī in this context belongs to the broad Mañjuśrī corpus; "great vidyā" translates mahāvidyā, a technical term for a powerful mantra or spell. The mantra body is transliterated as-is following standard practice for dhāraṇī passages, where the Sanskrit is transmitted phonetically through Tibetan script and no semantic translation is appropriate. The phrase "three hundred ślokas of human composition" refers to the memorization of three hundred verses of ordinary literary composition, a standard measure of extraordinary memory in Indian sources.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.